

# THE COASTAL PLAINS AND THE ISLANDS

## Chapter 6 Textbook Exercises — Model Answers & Explanations

---

### I. Quick Zone (Objective Questions)

#### A. Tick (☐) the correct options to complete the following sentences.

1. Andaman and Nicobar is \_\_\_\_\_.

**Correct Option: (d) both (b) & (c)**

*Explanation:* According to the text, the Andaman and Nicobar Islands is a **union territory** of India and is also a group of **islands** located in the Bay of Bengal [58].

2. The rivers that form deltas in the Eastern Coastal Plains are \_\_\_\_\_.

**Correct Option: (c) Mahanadi, Godavari, Krishna, Kaveri**

*Explanation:* The text states that the major rivers of the Eastern Coastal Plains are the Mahanadi in Odisha, the Godavari and Krishna in Andhra Pradesh, and the Kaveri in Tamil Nadu, and all of these form large deltas along the coast [56].

3. \_\_\_\_\_ separates Andaman from Nicobar Islands.

**Correct Option: (b) The Ten Degree Channel**

*Explanation:* The text explicitly states that **The Ten Degree Channel** separates the Andaman from the Nicobar Islands [58].

4. The southernmost point of the mainland of India is \_\_\_\_\_.

**Correct Option: (c) Kanyakumari**

*Explanation:* The extent of the coastal plains is from Gujarat to Kanyakumari in the south. Kanyakumari is the southernmost point of the Indian **mainland**, where the Eastern and Western Coastal Plains meet [54]. (Note: Indira Point is the southernmost point of the country as a whole, located in the Nicobar Islands [58, 59]).

5. The Northern Circars is a part of \_\_\_\_\_.

**Correct Option: (c) Eastern Coastal Plains**

*Explanation:* The Eastern Coastal Plains is divided into three parts: the Northern Circars (the region between the deltas of Mahanadi, Godavari, and Krishna), the Coromandel Coast, and the Utkal Coast [54, 55].

#### B. Fill in the blanks.

1. Visakhapatnam is a **seaport / ship building yard**.

*Explanation:* The text states that there is a big ship building yard at Visakhapatnam, which is an important port in Andhra Pradesh [55].

2. The Andaman and Nicobar Islands are located in the **Bay of Bengal**.

*Explanation:* The textbook notes that the Andaman and Nicobar Islands are situated in the Bay of Bengal [58].

3. The Lakshadweep are located in the **Arabian Sea**.

*Explanation:* The text notes that the Lakshadweep Islands are located in the Arabian Sea [58].

4. The Coromandel coast receives rain in **winters**.

*Explanation:* The text states that the Coromandel Coast of the Eastern Coastal Plains receives rains in winters and is often hit by cyclones [56].

### C. Write (T) for true statements and (F) for false statements.

1. The Kanara coast lies on the eastern coast. **(F)**

*Correction:* The Kanara Coast lies on the **Western Coastal Plains**, stretching from Goa to Mangaluru [55].

2. Sri Vijaya Puram is the capital of Andaman and Nicobar Islands. **(T)**

*Verification:* The text states that **Sri Vijaya Puram** is indeed the capital of Andaman and Nicobar Islands [58] (recently updated from its former name, Port Blair).

3. The main occupation of the people in the western coast is handicraft. **(F)**

*Correction:* The main occupations of the people in the coastal regions are **agriculture and fishing** [55].

4. Coral reefs are found in Lakshadweep Islands. **(T)**

*Verification:* The text confirms that the Lakshadweep Islands are surrounded by beautiful coral reefs and have been formed from coral deposits [59].

5. Visakhapatnam is a sea port in Karnataka. **(F)**

*Correction:* Visakhapatnam is an important seaport in **Andhra Pradesh**, not Karnataka [55].

### D. Match the columns A and B.

| Column A                       | Column B (Original)        | Correct Answer Match | Grounded Reference                                 |
|--------------------------------|----------------------------|----------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| 1. Andaman and Nicobar Islands | (i) Capital of Lakshadweep | (ii) Volcanic Origin | Some of these islands are volcanic in origin [58]. |

| Column A                   | Column B (Original)                      | Correct Answer Match                            | Grounded Reference                                                                |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>2. Puducherry</b>       | (ii) Volcanic Origin                     | <b>(v) Union territory</b>                      | Puducherry is a Union Territory in the coastal region [55].                       |
| <b>3. Kavaratti</b>        | (iii) Part of the Western Coastal Plains | <b>(i) Capital of Lakshadweep</b>               | Kavaratti is the capital of Lakshadweep [59].                                     |
| <b>4. Malabar Coast</b>    | (iv) Part of the Eastern Coastal Plains  | <b>(iii) Part of the Western Coastal Plains</b> | The Malabar Coast is the western coast from Mangaluru to Kanyakumari [55].        |
| <b>5. Coromandel Coast</b> | (v) Union territory                      | <b>(iv) Part of the Eastern Coastal Plains</b>  | Coromandel is the southeastern coastal region of the Eastern Coastal Plains [55]. |

## II. Writing Zone (Subjective Questions & Detailed Answers)

---

### Q1. Differentiate between Eastern Coastal Plains and Western Coastal Plains.

**Answer:**

The primary differences between the Eastern Coastal Plains and the Western Coastal Plains are as follows:

- **Location:** The Eastern Coastal Plains lie between the Eastern Ghats and the Bay of Bengal [54]. The Western Coastal Plains lie between the Western Ghats and the Arabian Sea [55].
- **Width:** The Eastern Coastal Plains are wider and broader than the Western Coastal Plains, which are narrower [54, 55].
- **Rivers and Deltas:** The Eastern Coastal Plains are characterized by major rivers like the Mahanadi, Godavari, Krishna, and Kaveri, which flow eastwards and form large, fertile, and thickly populated deltas along the coast [54, 56]. On the other hand, the rivers of the Western Coastal Plains (such as Tapi, Narmada, Mandovi, and Zuari) flow rapidly and do not form large deltas; instead, they form estuaries, backwaters, and lagoons [56].
- **Divisions:** The Eastern Coastal Plains are divided into three parts: The Northern Circars, The Coromandel Coast, and The Utkal Coast [54, 55]. The Western Coastal Plains are divided into four parts: The Gujarat Coast, The Konkan Coast, The Kanara Coast, and The Malabar Coast [55].

### Q2. Name two ports in Tamil Nadu.

**Answer:**

The two major ports located in the state of Tamil Nadu are **Chennai** and **Tuticorin**, which are vital for international trade and maritime commerce [55].

### Q3. Name three Union Territories located in South India.

**Answer:**

According to the chapter, three Union Territories located in or around Southern India are:

1. **Puducherry** (located on the east coast, bordering Tamil Nadu) [55].
2. **Lakshadweep** (an island group located in the Arabian Sea off the coast of Kerala) [58, 59].
3. **Andaman and Nicobar Islands** (an island group located in the Bay of Bengal) [58].

### Q4. Name the crops grown in the Eastern Coastal Plains and Western Coastal Plains respectively.

**Answer:**

Agriculture is a primary occupation in both coastal regions [55]:

- **Western Coastal Plains:** Due to hot and humid weather, fertile soil, and heavy monsoonal rain, crops such as **cotton, groundnut, coconut, jute, cashew nut, sugarcane, rice, and spices** are majorly grown [55, 56].
- **Eastern Coastal Plains:** The extremely fertile and well-irrigated deltas formed by the Mahanadi, Godavari, Krishna, and Kaveri rivers make this plain ideal for growing **rice (paddy)** as a primary crop, along with coconut and sugarcane [56].

**Q5. What are lagoons? Where are they found?****Answer:**

- **Definition:** Lagoons are shallow saltwater bodies or lakes that are separated from the open sea by low sandbanks, barrier islands, or rocks [60].
- **Location:** In India, a large number of lagoons (locally known as *Kaya/s* or backwaters) are found along the **Malabar Coast in the extreme south** (primarily in Kerala) [55, 56, 60]. These lagoons serve as a major tourist attraction and support local inland water transportation and fishing [56].

**Q6. Which are the two island groups in our country? Where are they located?****Answer:**

The two major island groups of India are:

1. **The Andaman and Nicobar Islands:** Located in the **Bay of Bengal** in the east. They are a group of about 300 hilly, volcanic, and heavily forested islands [58, 60].
2. **The Lakshadweep Islands:** Located in the **Arabian Sea** in the west. They are a smaller group of about 43 flat islands formed from coral deposits off the Kerala coast [58, 59, 60].

### III. Critical Thinking & Application Zones

---

**Critical Thinking: Occupations and Geography in Coastal Areas****Critical Thinking Zone Answer:**

Occupations in India's coastal regions are deeply tied to geographic features:

- **Agriculture & Farming:** On the Western Coast, heavy rainfall and fertile soil allow crops like spices, cashew nuts, and coconuts to thrive. On the Eastern Coast, the fertile river deltas are primarily dedicated to intensive rice cultivation [55, 56].
- **Fishing & Marine Occupations:** Fishing is a massive industry in both plains due to the proximity to the Arabian Sea and the Bay of Bengal, which are rich in marine life. In Kerala's backwaters and Lakshadweep, fishing and shell-gathering are core survival activities [55, 59].
- **Maritime Trade & Port Labor:** The presence of natural and artificial harbours (like Kandla, Mumbai, Cochin, Chennai, and Visakhapatnam) creates vast employment in shipping, cargo handling, and international trade [55]. Visakhapatnam additionally houses a major ship-building yard [55].
- **Manufacturing and Mining:** Salt manufacturing is crucial on the dry Gujarat coast [57]. Petroleum, mining (iron ore and minerals in Goa), and textiles are other major coastal industrial employers [57].
- **Tourism:** Beautiful beaches (e.g., Calangute in Goa, Kovalam in Kerala) and historical sites (Cellular Jail in Andaman) drive a thriving hospitality and tourism sector [56, 57, 59].

## Problem Solving: Mapping India's Western Seaports

### Problem Solving Zone (Map Work Guidance):

To accurately mark and label the major seaports on an outline map of India, students should locate them from north to south along the Western Coast as follows:

1. **Kandla:** Located in the Gulf of Kutch on the **Gujarat Coast** [55, 57].
2. **Mumbai & JN Port:** Located adjacent to each other on the **Konkan Coast** of Maharashtra [55].
3. **Marmagao:** Located on the coast of **Goa** [55, 57].
4. **Mangaluru:** Located on the **Kanara Coast** of Karnataka [55].
5. **Kochi (Cochin):** Located on the **Malabar Coast** of Kerala [55, 57].

## Digi Zone: Tourism and Heritage Research

### Digi Zone Student Research Project:

- **The Cellular Jail (Kala Pani), Andaman Islands:** Constructed by the British, the Cellular Jail was a notorious colonial prison used to exile Indian freedom fighters [59]. Located in Port Blair (Sri Vijaya Puram), it stands today as a national memorial symbolizing the immense sacrifices of India's independence struggle [58, 59].
- **Coral Reefs of Lakshadweep:** Lakshadweep is a breathtaking archipelago of 43 coral islands formed entirely from the skeletons of tiny marine organisms called polyps [59, 60]. These vibrant coral reefs support a diverse range of marine biodiversity, making tourism and ecological research key attractions of the territory [59].